

Visualization Design Canvas

Template

Magdalena A. Tkacz

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Visualization Design Canvas

Design before code.

Project

Project title

Write a short working title.

Author

Your name.

Date

Today's date.

1. Dataset

Dataset

Name

Dataset name.

Source

Where does it come from? Include URL if available.

Description

Describe the dataset in 2–3 sentences.

Data inventory

Observations

What does one row represent?

Variables

List the most important variables.

Data quality

Potential issues

Missing values? Outliers? Bias? Measurement errors?

2. Audience

Who is your audience?

Describe your target audience.

Background knowledge

What do they already know?

List the assumptions.

What do they probably not know?

List the knowledge gaps.

Desired outcome

What should they understand?

Write one or two sentences.

What should they remember after viewing your visualization?

Write one key message.

3. Goal

Main objective

What is the purpose of your visualization?

Decision

What decision should the audience be able to make?

Key question

Write the single most important question your visualization should answer.

4. Understanding the data

Variables

Variable	Type	Notes
<i>Name</i>	<i>Continuous / Categorical / Ordinal / Temporal / Spatial / ...</i>	<i>Comments</i>

Relationships

Which variables seem to be related?

Interesting patterns

What do you expect to discover?

5. Design ideas

Possible visualizations

List several possible visualization types.

- —
- —
- —

Why these?

Explain why these visualizations might work.

6. Visual mapping

Data → Visual attributes

Data	Visual attribute	Why?
<i>Variable</i>	<i>Position / Color / Size / Shape / ...</i>	<i>Reason</i>

Visual hierarchy

First

What should attract attention first?

Second

What should be noticed next?

Third

What should the viewer explore afterwards?

7. Sketches

Idea A

Draw a quick sketch.

Why?

Idea B

Draw a quick sketch.

Why?

Idea C

Draw a quick sketch.

Why?

8. Design review

Reflection

Is the message clear?

Yes / No — explain.

Is the visualization appropriate for the audience?

Explain.

Is there anything unnecessary?

What could be removed?

What could be improved?

List possible improvements.

9. Implementation plan

Tool

Which software or library will you use?

Why?

Explain why you selected this tool.

Next step

Describe the first implementation task.

Notes

Additional observations, ideas, references or questions.